

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Legal Assistant position at your Reading firm, advertised through Reed. With a Law LLB (2:1) from UCL, an LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution (Merit) from Queen Mary, and practical legal experience spanning a City disputes practice, a legal clinic and frontline advice work, I am looking for a role where I can contribute immediately and develop further within a supportive, forward-thinking team.

At Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, I spent a year embedded in active disputes work — six months in International Arbitration and six months in Real Estate Disputes. I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions, prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, drafted procedural histories and procedural orders, managed case files on iManage, tracked deadlines across competing matters and liaised directly with clients on document requirements. Towards a significant arbitration deadline I became the only junior supporting the team and coordinated the submission process end to end; a partner and associate noted that my performance was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor.

More recently, as a Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, I manage a varied caseload independently — taking detailed client statements, researching complex legal points, drafting correspondence, preparing application packs and maintaining accurate, confidential case records. I am used to translating procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients under pressure, and to meeting firm deadlines without close supervision.

I am organised, precise and genuinely motivated by legal work done well. I am based locally and am attracted both by the firm's reputation and by the opportunity for structured professional development that the role offers.

I would welcome the chance to discuss how my background fits your team's needs.

Yours faithfully,
Maria Silva